

ELEVATE Foundation

**Understanding Behaviors, Awareness, Influences, and
Support for quitting**

Vihaan Ganganala,
Founder of the ELEVATE Nonprofit Foundation



OUR MISSION

ELEVATE's mission is to prevent teen nicotine addiction by empowering young people with research-driven education, peer-led awareness, and accessible support, therefore protecting adolescent health and strengthening communities.

MEMBER



Founder & CEO

Vihaan Ganganala

Vihaan Ganganala is a high school student researcher and founder of ELEVATE, a youth-led initiative focused on preventing teen nicotine addiction through research, education, and community engagement. He is involved in HOSA and public health advocacy and is passionate about improving adolescent health outcomes.

TRACTION

- Surveyed 445+ students on teen vaping behavior, awareness, and influences
- Built a youth-led research project presented through HOSA and community channels
- Engaged students across multiple grade levels and schools
- Launched ELEVATE as a student-founded, community-focused initiative
- Initiated conversations with local and state leaders about prevention funding and support

PROBLEMS

- Teen vaping is now the most common form of nicotine use among adolescents.
- Millions of middle and high school students use nicotine through e-cigarettes.
- Most teens underestimate the risks and do not realize how addictive vaping is.
- Nicotine exposure during adolescence alters brain development and increases long-term addiction and mental health risks.
- Schools and communities lack effective, teen-centered prevention and quitting support.



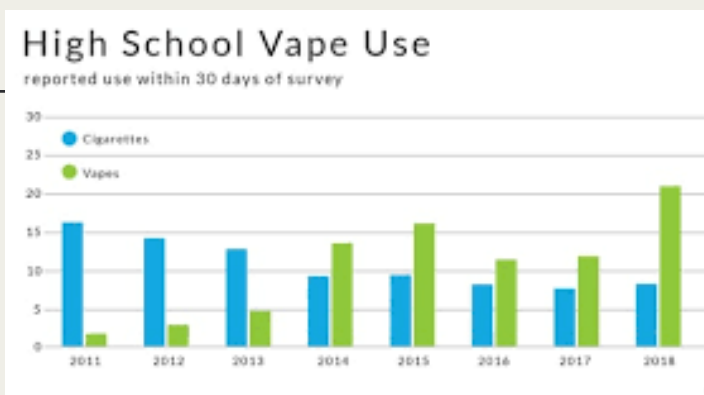
WHY NOW?

- Teen vaping has rapidly replaced smoking as the primary form of nicotine use among youth.
- New high-nicotine devices and flavored products continue to enter the market faster than policy and education can keep up.
- Teens are being exposed earlier, increasing the likelihood of long-term addiction.
- Schools and communities are struggling to respond with limited resources and outdated programs.
- Early intervention is most effective before addiction becomes entrenched.
- This is a critical window to prevent a new generation from developing lifelong nicotine dependence.

THE GAP

- Existing prevention programs are adult-designed and not aligned with teen behavior or culture.
- Current policies focuses on rules and punishment rather than understanding, motivation, and support.
- Teens lack access to credible, relatable, and non-judgmental education about vaping.
- Quitting resources are designed for adults and are not accessible or appealing to teens.
- Schools and communities lack data-driven, youth-centered tools to address vaping effectively.

SOLUTIONS: ELEVATE



Student-Led Prevention & Awareness Campaigns

We will design and deliver peer-to-peer vaping prevention campaigns using evidence-based, teen-friendly messaging that reflects real student behavior and social influence.

Expanded Data Analysis & Research

We will deepen analysis of YRBS and NYTS data and expand research across Kansas regions to identify trends, risk factors, and high-impact prevention opportunities.

School-Based Prevention Programs

We will pilot structured prevention modules in schools, focusing on high-risk grades and incorporating stress management and decision-making education.

Community & Parent Education Outreach

We will equip parents and communities with tools to recognize vaping behaviors, reduce access, and support prevention beyond the school environment.

IMPACT MODEL

Input:

Funding enables program development, research tools, educational materials, partnerships, and student leadership training.

Activities:

We will run student-led prevention campaigns, expand data analysis, pilot school programs, engage parents and communities, and share findings statewide.

Outputs:

Number of students reached, schools partnered with, prevention sessions delivered, data reports created, and families engaged.

Short-Term Outcomes:

Increased awareness of vaping risks, improved understanding of addiction, reduced social normalization, and greater student engagement in prevention.

Medium-Term Outcomes:

Reduced vaping initiation, increased quitting attempts, healthier coping strategies, and improved school environments.

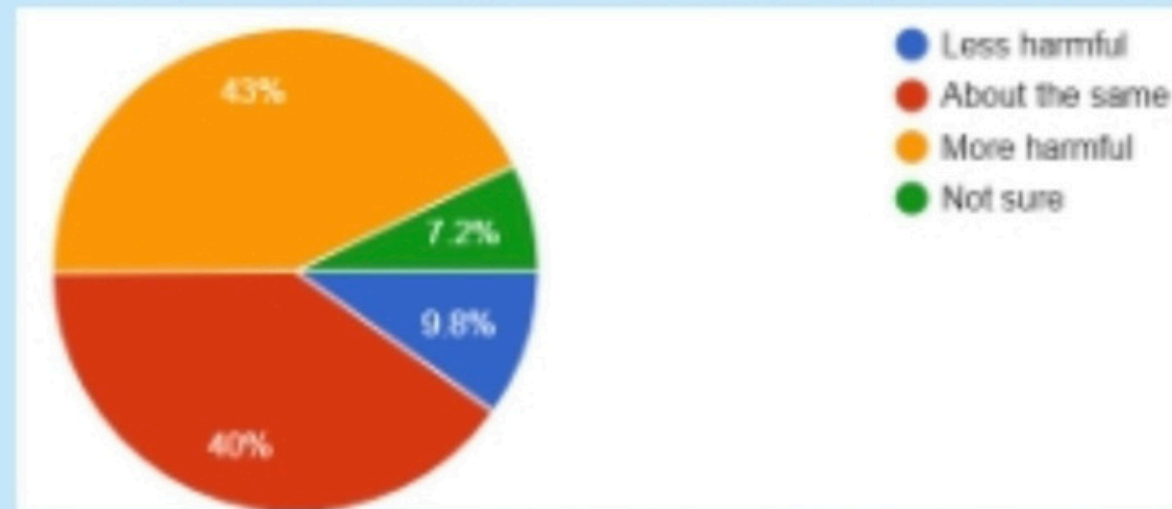
Long-Term Impact:

Lower teen nicotine addiction rates, improved adolescent health and mental well-being, and reduced long-term public health and social costs.

EVIDENCE

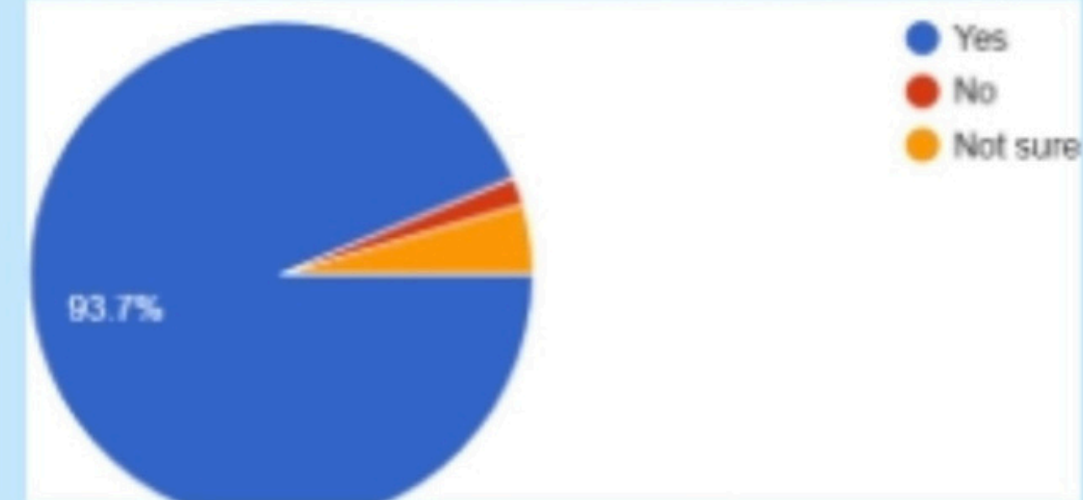
Awareness & Knowledge

Youth Perceptions of Vaping Harm Compared to Cigarettes



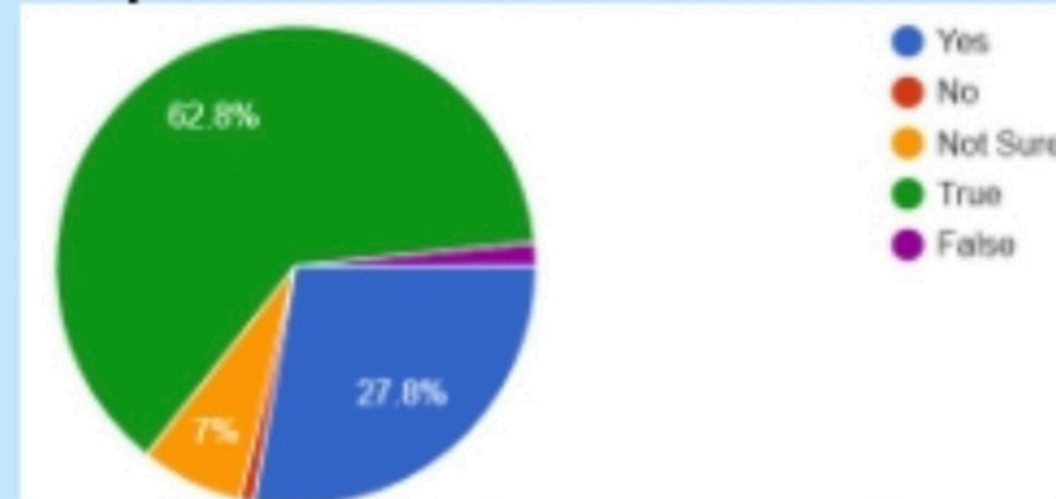
Most students believe vaping is as harmful or more harmful than cigarettes, while few perceive it as less harmful.

Perceived Nicotine Addiction Risk of Vaping



Nearly all students believe vaping can lead to nicotine addiction.

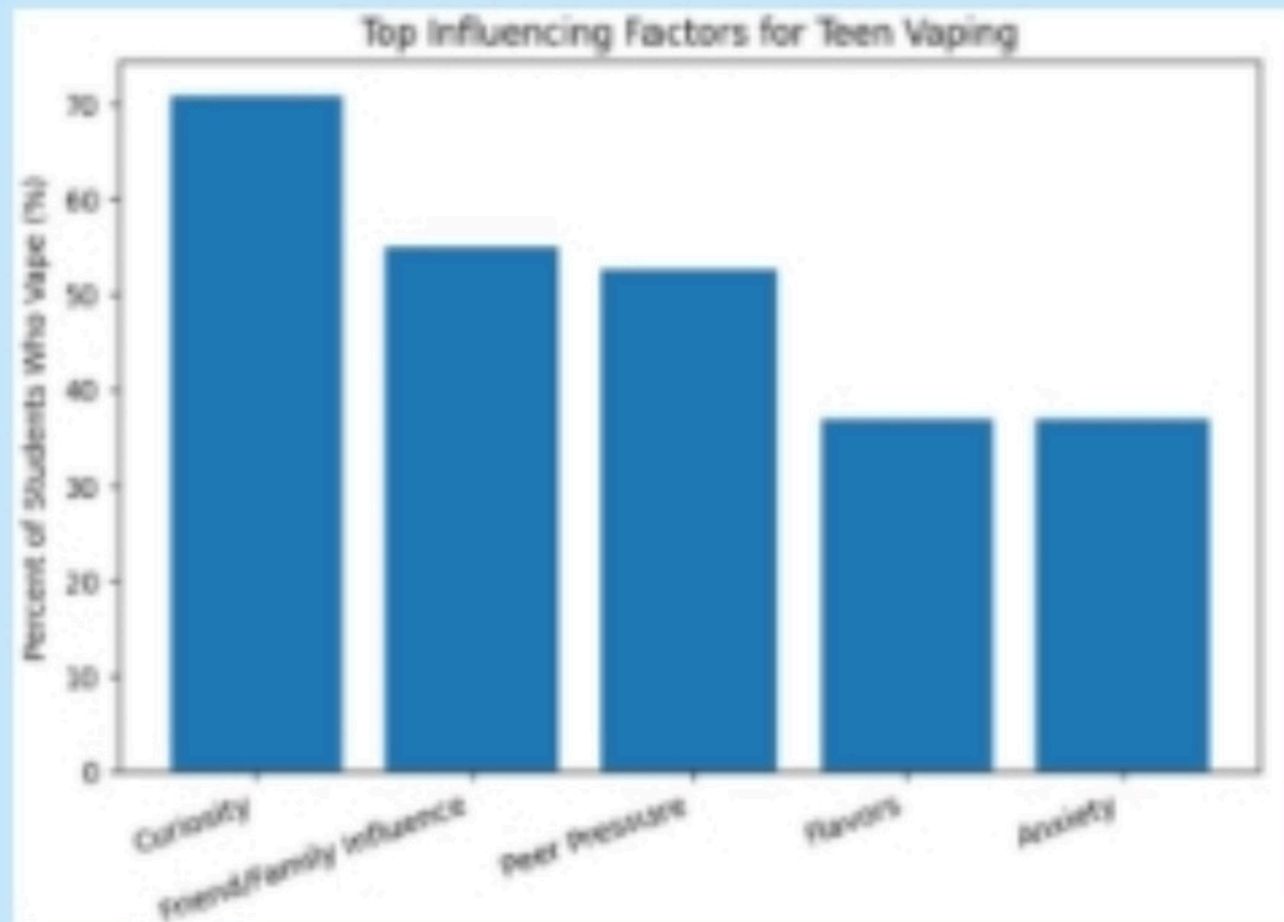
Perceived Impact of Nicotine on Teen Brain Development



Most students believe vaping negatively affects teen brain development.

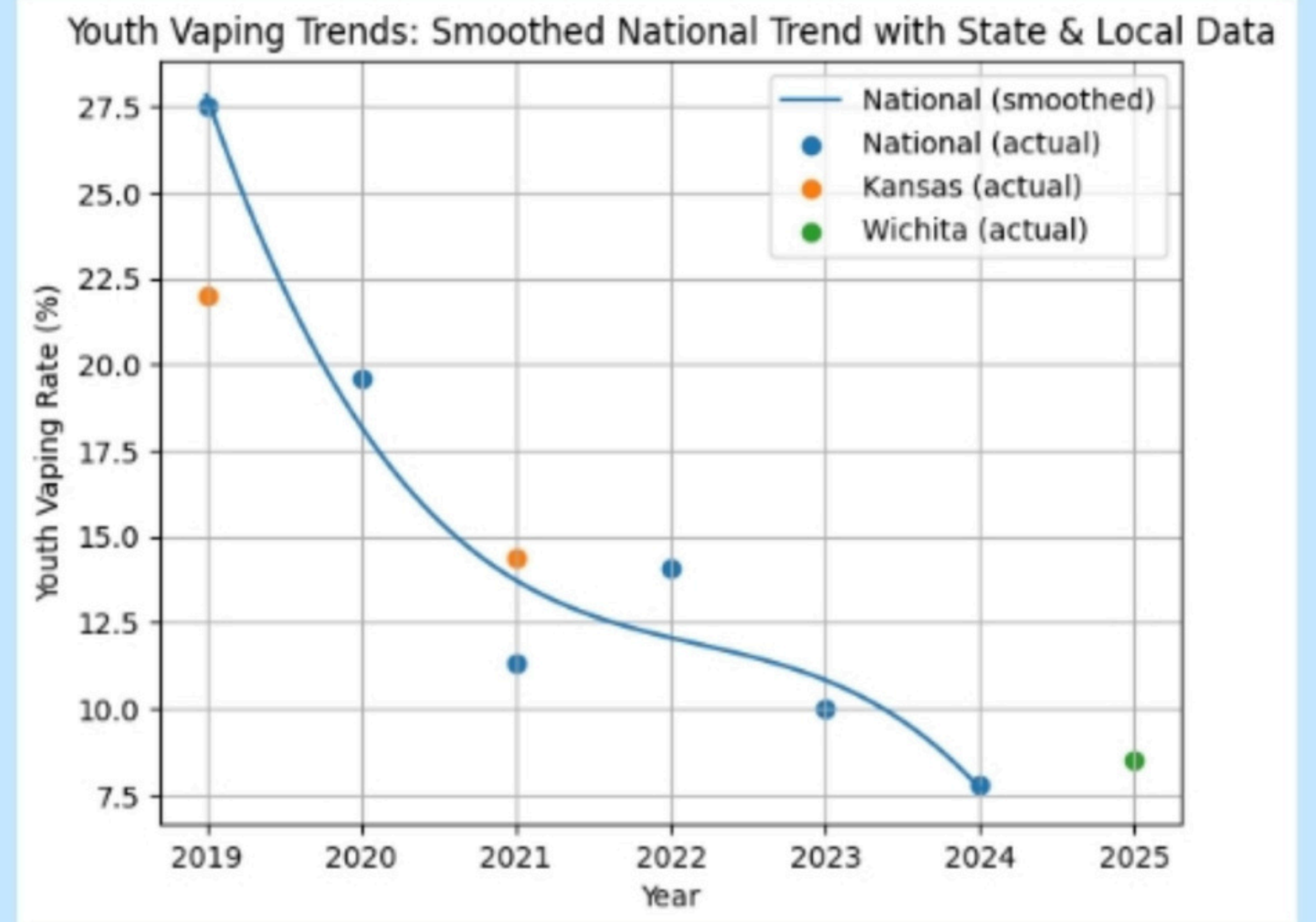
EVIDENCE

Attitude and Influences



Curiosity, peer influence, and peer pressure were the most commonly reported factors contributing to teen vaping.

National & Kansas Comparison



National youth vaping rates have declined over time. Local data from Wichita show a slightly higher prevalence than the national average, but remain well below Kansas state levels, aligning with broader downward trends.

SCALE & SUSTAINABILITY

Replication Through Student Leadership

By training student leaders, the program naturally renews each year as older students mentor new ones, making growth low-cost and sustainable.

Data-Driven Adaptation

Ongoing research and feedback will allow us to continuously refine and improve programs to remain effective across different communities.

Multi-Source Funding Model

We will pursue a mix of grants, school partnerships, sponsorships, and public health funding to reduce reliance on any single source.

Integration into Existing Systems

We will embed programs into school health curricula, HOSA chapters, and community organizations to ensure long-term continuation beyond initial funding.

THE ASK

Funding Request

We are seeking funding to launch and expand ELEVATE's teen vaping prevention initiatives across schools and communities in Kansas.

Use of Funds

Funding will support research expansion, development of prevention materials, school-based pilot programs, student leadership training, and community outreach.

What This Enables

This investment allows us to reach more students earlier, improve prevention effectiveness, and reduce long-term health and social costs associated with teen nicotine addiction.



CLOSING



Our Vision

We envision a future where teens are informed, empowered, and supported to make healthy choices, and where nicotine addiction is prevented before it begins.

Why It Matters

Teen vaping is a solvable problem, but only if we act early, intentionally, and with youth at the center of the solution.

Invitation

We invite you to partner with us in protecting adolescent health and shaping healthier futures for our communities. By investing in ELEVATE, you're not just funding a program, you're helping prevent addiction, protect developing brains, and give young people a healthier start to adulthood.



THANK YOU

ELEVATE

